

The anointed cherub that covereth

In **Ezekiel 28:14** Satan is called “*the anointed cherub that covereth*”; but, what does that mean?

Verse	Tense
Ezekiel 28:13-16 ¹³ Thou hast been in Eden the garden of God; every precious stone was thy covering, the sardius, topaz, and the diamond, the beryl, the onyx, and the jasper, the sapphire, the emerald, and the carbuncle, and gold: the workmanship of thy tabrets* and of thy pipes* was prepared in thee in the day that thou wast created.	past
¹⁴ Thou art the anointed** cherub that covereth ; and I have set thee so:	Present
¹⁴ thou wast upon the holy mountain of God; thou hast walked up and down in the midst of the stones of fire.	past
¹⁵ Thou wast perfect in thy ways from the day that thou wast created, till iniquity was found in thee. ¹⁶ By the multitude of thy merchandise they have filled the midst of thee with violence, and thou hast sinned:	past
¹⁶ therefore I will cast thee as profane out of the mountain of God: and I will destroy thee, O covering cherub , from the midst of the stones of fire.	future

- The (singular) anointed cherub.
- Take note that the first part of verse **14** is present tense.
- Take note that verse **16** says “*the midst of thee*”. People or creatures are never described in scripture as being “filled with violence” as in an internal reference to the creature itself. This appears to be a spatial reference as in every other usage of the phrase “with violence” (**Genesis 6:11,13, Ezekiel 8:17, Zephaniah 1:9, Revelation 18:21**).
 - The midst is the container (the space covered by the cherub).
 - The violence is the material that occupies that space.

* The tabret (or tabor) is historically a hand-held drum that produces lower frequencies (Alto/Bass; 60-200Hz). The pipes are historically wind instruments that produce higher frequencies (Soprano/Tenor; 500-3,000+Hz). The human hearing range is 20-20,000Hz and as we age the higher frequency limit drops to around 12,000-15,000Hz. Most speech and music is in the 250-4,000Hz range. This verse tells us that Lucifer was given the ability to simultaneously produce both lower and higher frequency sounds. So, was he Alto or Soprano? Yes.

** “anointed” (מִשְׁחָ *mimšach* H4473) here in the 1524 Bomberg MT is a *hapax legomenon* (this **unique** Hebrew form of the root M-Sh-Ch is marked in the Masora Parva with the letter ל *Lamed*, which means *leit* or “none other”). It is different from every other form of the root in the OT: the verb form “to anoint” מָשַׁח (*māšāḥ* 68x H4886), the noun form “Messiah/Anointed One” מָשִׁיחַ (*māšîaḥ* 39x H4899), and the noun form “anointing/ointment” מִשְׁחָה (*mišḥāh* 21x H4888). Because this form only appears once in the entire OT there are two schools of thought as to the definition of the Hebrew word:

- Contextually (a noun of status)
 - Set apart by God for a purpose.
- Grammar & cognate languages (David Kimhi – RaDaK [Rabbi David Kimhi]; 1160-1235AD; Narbonne, France)
 - Because the root M-Sh-Ch (that H4473 is based on) is frequently used for measuring or extending (like a measure of oil or land) some assert that *mimšach* is a noun of extension.
 - In Aramaic, *meshach* refers to measuring or spreading out. Since the very next word in the verse is חֹסֶכָה (*hassôkēk* - “*that covereth*”), it makes logical sense that “*anointed*” actually describes the *physical span* (eg. “The Cherub of outspread [wings] that covereth”).

The words “cherub” (singular) or “cherubims” (plural) appear 95 times in 78 verses.

Cherub (30x in 21 verses)	Exo 25:19, 37:8 2Sa 22:11 1Ki 6:24,25,26,27 2Ch 3:11,12 Ezr 2:59 (a locative noun) Neh 7:61 (a locative noun) Psa 18:10 Eze 9:3, 10:2,4,7,9,14, 28:14,16, 41:18
Cherubims (65x in 57 verses)	Gen 3:24 (“C” is capitalized and it’s not the beginning of a sentence or a statement) Exo 25:18,19,20,22, 26:1,31, 36:8,35, 37:7,8,9 Num 7:89 1Sa 4:4, 6:2 1Ki 6:23,25,27,28,29,32,35, 7:29,36, 8:6,7 2Ki 19:15 1Ch 13:6, 28:18 2Ch 3:7,10,11,13,14, 5:7,8 Psa 80:1, 99:1 Isa 37:16 Eze 10:1,2,3,5,6,7,8,9,15,16,18,19,20, 11:22, 41:18,20,25 Heb 9:5

Chasing the White Rabbit

Genesis 1:6-8 ⁶ And God said, Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters. ⁷ And God made the firmament, and divided the waters which were under the firmament from the waters which were above the firmament: and it was so. ⁸ And God called the firmament Heaven. And the evening and the morning were the second day.	1 Kings 8:27 (2Ch 2:6, 2Ch 6:18, Neh 9:6) But will God indeed dwell on the earth? behold, the heaven and heaven of heavens cannot contain thee; how much less this house that I have builded?
Genesis 1:14-15 ¹⁴ And God said, Let there be lights in the firmament of the heaven to divide the day from the night; and let them be for signs, and for seasons, and for days, and years: ¹⁵ And let them be for lights in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth: and it was so.	

- The heaven is the physical expanse surrounding the Earth, also known as the sky or the atmosphere.
- The “*firmament of the heaven*” is where the physical stars (“*lights in the firmament [heaven] of the heaven*” **Genesis 1:15**) are (*tou aitheros*; outer space).
- The “*heaven [singular] of heavens [plural; the sky and outer space]*” is the same third heaven in **2 Corinthians 12:2** which of course is the abode of God (**Luke 23:43, Revelation 2:7**).

The Looking-Glass is Cracking

Let's see what the commentators have to say about this "*anointed cherub that covereth*". The following is a summary of the prevailing opinions and how we can rule each of them out as viable interpretations.

- **A Pre-fall Lucifer**
 - [Ezekiel 28:14](#) is present tense.
- **The cherubim on the Ark ([Exodus 30:26](#), [Psalm 80:1](#), [99:1](#))**
 - There are two cherub's on the Ark, not one ([Ezekiel 28:14](#) "**Thou** [singular] art **the** [singular] anointed cherub"). One could argue that they are one because they are both part of the Ark but that hypothesis has no support elsewhere in scripture (unlike the vail).
- **The human king of Tyrus (Ethbaal III) as a type of Adam**
 - It's all a metaphorical description of the king of Tyrus and has nothing to do with Satan. The anointed cherub describes the king's divinely appointed position and his role as a protector of his people. The description using "Eden" and "precious stones" is simply hyperbolic language to describe the peak of Tyrian commercial and political power. The mountain is a description of the high, fortified island-city of Tyrus which sat above the mainland settlement. The stones of fire are gemstones that the Tyrians traded.
 - While admittedly clever, it's devoid of the Spirit ([1Cor 2:13,14](#)) and it denies the literal interpretation of scripture thereby exalting man to the position of interpreting God's word which is idolatry.
 - Completely ignores the shift from "prince of Tyrus" to "king of Tyrus" and groups them both together.
- **The king of Tyrus as the guardian of the sanctuary**
 - Some take the Hebrew meaning of "covereth" (*sakak*) which is "hedging/protecting" (while completely ignoring the English meaning) and suggest that the king of Tyrus saw himself (or was intended to be) a guardian of the religious or economic stability of the region much like the cherubims that guarded the way to the tree of life or covered the mercy seat. The iniquity found in him, according to this view, was the perversion of this protective role by self-deification ([Ezekiel 28:2](#)).
 - Again, it's quite clever, but it has the same problems the previous interpretation did in addition to both of them lacking support elsewhere in scripture (the interpretations start and end where they began which is a dead end unless we likewise twist scripture elsewhere to say what it doesn't say).

Taking the Path that Leads Backward

A Cherub (singular) is only explicitly written of in a total of nineteen verses (excluding the two that are place names in both [Ezra 2:59](#) and [Nehemiah 7:61](#); see table above for the full list).

Of those nineteen only seven of them are about a singular cherub ([2 Samuel 22:11](#), [Psalm 18:10](#), [Ezekiel 9:3](#), [10:2,4](#), [28:14,16](#)).

Of those seven only two are not in the book of [Ezekiel](#). And those two are parallel passages. Interesting.

The Garden of Live Flowers

2 Samuel 22:11

And he rode **upon a cherub**, and did fly: and he was seen **upon the wings of the wind**.

Psalms 18:10

And he rode **upon a cherub**, and did fly: yea, he did fly **upon the wings of the wind**.

- When God the Father rescued God the Son after His crucifixion, He rode upon a [singular] cherub.

Exodus 24:10

And they saw the God of Israel: and **there was under his feet** as it were a paved work of a sapphire stone, and **as it were the body of heaven in his clearness**.

Isaiah 66:1

Thus saith the LORD, **The heaven is my throne, and the earth is my footstool**: where is the house that ye build unto me? and where is the place of my rest?

Matthew 5:34-35

³⁴ But I say unto you, Swear not at all; neither by **heaven**; for it **is God's throne**: ³⁵ Nor by **the earth**; for it **is his footstool**: neither by Jerusalem; for it is the city of the great King.

1 Chronicles 28:2, Psalm 11:4, 132:7, Matthew 23:22, Acts 7:49

- It's abundantly *clear* where God's throne is and where his footstool is.

Ezekiel 1:5 (13,15,19)

Also out of the midst thereof came the likeness of **four living creatures**. And this was their appearance; they had the likeness of a man.

Ezekiel 1:22 (20,21)

And the likeness of the firmament upon the heads of the **living creature** was as the colour of the terrible crystal, stretched forth over their heads above.

Ezekiel 10:20

This is the **living creature** that I saw under the God of Israel by the river of Chebar; and I knew that they were the **cherubims**.

- The “*four living creatures*” (cherubims) are all referred to as a singular “*living creature*”.

Ezekiel 10:1-4 (1:22-26; 9:3)

¹ Then I looked, and, behold, in the firmament that was above the head of the cherubims there appeared over them as it were a sapphire stone ^{Exo 24:10, Eze 1:22,26, 10:1, Rev 4:6}, as the appearance of the likeness of a throne. ² And he spake unto the man clothed with linen ^{Eze 9:2,4}, and said, Go in between the wheels ^{Eze 1:18}, even under **the cherub**, and fill thine hand with coals of fire from between the cherubims, and scatter them over the city. And he went in in my sight. ³ Now the cherubims stood on the right side of the house, when the man went in; and the cloud filled the inner court. ⁴ Then the glory of the LORD went up from **the cherub**, and stood over the threshold of the house; and the house was filled with the cloud, and the court was full of the brightness of the LORD'S glory.

- Above the “living creature/cherubims” (and the dreadfully high wheels beside them and the coals of fire between them) is the firmament/heaven.
- The singular “*living creature*” (which is below the throne in the firmament) is referred to as “*the cherub*”.
- This is very likely the cherub that the LORD rode upon in 2 Samuel 22:11 & Psalm 18:10.

Finding the Eighth Square

Ephesians 2:2 (5:6, John 3:18)

Wherein in time past ye walked according to the course of this world, according to **the prince of the power of the air**, the **spirit that now worketh in** the children of disobedience:

- References to spiritual creatures in the air: Job 28:21, Matthew 13:4, Mark 4:4,32, Luke 8:5, 13:19 (cf. Matthew 13:24-30).
- Lucifer is called the prince/chief/captain/first/commander/ruler of “*the power* [authority/jurisdiction] of *the air* [tou aeros/atmosphere/the covering of the earth]”.
 - Air (*tou aeros*) here is analogous to “the [first] heaven” or “the firmament” (the sky).
- Thus, physically, Lucifer rules over the atmosphere that covers the earth, for the time being (Isaiah 34:4, Revelation 6:13,14)
- That same **spirit** is said to work **in** (present tense), as in inside of, the children of disobedience.

The Gnat’s Small Whisper

2 Corinthians 4:3-4

³ But if our gospel be hid, it is hid to them that are lost: ⁴ In whom **the god of this world hath blinded the minds** of them which believe not, lest the light of the glorious gospel of Christ, who is the image of God, should shine unto them.

1 Samuel 28:9,13

⁹ And the woman said unto him, Behold, thou knowest what Saul hath done, how he hath cut off **those that have familiar spirits**, and the wizards, out of the land: wherefore then layest thou a snare for my life, to cause me to die?

¹³ And the king said unto her, Be not afraid: for what savest thou? And the woman said unto Saul, **I saw gods ascending out of the earth.**

- The word “god/gods” is sometimes used to describe spirits.
- The “god of this world” is the same “spirit” of Ephesians 2:2 and the same “man” of Isaiah 14:16,17.

Waking the Dreamer

Isaiah 25:6-8

⁶ And in this mountain shall the LORD of hosts make unto all people a feast of fat things, a feast of wines on the lees, of fat things full of marrow, of wines on the lees well refined. ⁷ And **he will destroy in this mountain** ^{Isa 24:23} **the face of the covering cast over all people**, and **the vail that is spread over all nations.** ⁸ He will swallow up death in victory ^{1Cor 15:26}; and the Lord GOD will wipe away tears from off **all faces**; and the rebuke of his people shall he take away from off all the earth: for the LORD hath spoken it.

Revelation 21:4 (the new heaven and earth; not Revelation 7:17 the tribulation saints)

And God shall **wipe away all tears from their eyes**; and there shall be no more death, neither sorrow, nor crying, neither shall there be any more pain: for the former things are passed away.

- The time period for Isaiah 25:6,7 (not 8) is Revelation 19 so we know this occurs before the new heaven and the new earth meaning it is not a physical destruction of the atmosphere of Earth.
- Something spiritual that is a covering cast over all people will be destroyed (Hebrews 2:14).
- Interestingly, the “covering” is also called a “vail” (Exodus 26:31,33,35).

The Wood Where Things Have No Names

Isaiah 60:1-3

¹ Arise, shine; for thy light is come, and the glory of the LORD is risen upon thee. ² For, behold, the darkness shall cover the earth, and gross darkness the people: but the LORD shall arise upon thee, and his glory shall be seen upon thee. ³ And the Gentiles shall come to thy light, and kings to the brightness of thy rising.

John 1:4-5

⁴ In him was life; and the life was the light of men. ⁵ And the light shineth in darkness; and the darkness comprehended it not.

John 8:12

Then spake Jesus again unto them, saying, I am the light of the world: he that followeth me shall not walk in darkness, but shall have the light of life.

John 12:46

I am come a light into the world, that whosoever believeth on me should not abide in darkness.

Ephesians 4:17-18

¹⁷ This I say therefore, and testify in the Lord, that ye henceforth walk not as other Gentiles walk, in the vanity of their mind, ¹⁸ Having the understanding darkened, being alienated from the life of God through the ignorance that is in them, because of the blindness of their heart:

1 John 2:10-11

¹⁰ He that loveth his brother abideth in the light, and there is none occasion of stumbling in him. ¹¹ But he that hateth his brother is in darkness, and walketh in darkness, and knoweth not whither he goeth, because that darkness hath blinded his eyes.

- The “covering/vail” of Isaiah 25:6-8 covers the hearts/minds of people.
- Spiritual blindness affects the understanding and the heart/mind (2 Corinthians 3:14, 4:4).

The Old Sheep's Shop

John 8:43-47 (cf. Matthew 13:14,15, Isaiah 6:9,10)

⁴³ Why do ye not understand my speech? even because ye cannot hear my word. ⁴⁴ Ye are of your father the devil, and the lusts of your father ye will do. He was a murderer from the beginning, and abode not in the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he speaketh a lie, he speaketh of his own: for he is a liar, and the father of it. ⁴⁵ And because I tell you the truth, ye believe me not. ⁴⁶ Which of you convinceth me of sin? And if I say the truth, why do ye not believe me? ⁴⁷ He that is of God heareth God's words: ye therefore hear them not, because ye are not of God.

- Those who are spiritually blind cannot:
 - Understand the word of God.
 - Hear the word of God.
 - Believe the word of God.
- Lucifer cannot speak the word of God.

Moreover,

- Cannot (present indicative tense) see the kingdom of God (John 3:3, Luke 17:21).
- Are walking in darkness (1 John 2:11, 12:35).
- Experience tribulation and anguish (Romans 2:8,9).
- Cannot understand the mysteries of the kingdom of heaven (Matthew 13:11,12).
- All the curses in Deuteronomy 28? (John 7:49, Galatians 3:10).
- And more.

The physical as a shadow of the spiritual reality

1 Corinthians 3:16

Know ye not that **ye are the temple of God**, and that the Spirit of God dwelleth in you?

1 Corinthians 6:19

What? know ye not that **your body is the temple of the Holy Ghost** which is in you, which ye have of God, and ye are not your own?

- The tabernacle/temple is a part of the shadow of things to come but not the very image of those things (**Genesis 1:26,27**, **Hebrews 10:1**).
- The covering/vail blocks access to the heart/mind of the person.
 - Only the High Priest can enter (**Leviticus 16:2,17,34**, **Hebrews 3:1**, **1 Peter 1:23**).

2 Corinthians 3:13-16

¹³ And **not as Moses** ^[physical], which put a vail over his face, that the children of Israel could not stedfastly look to the end of that which is abolished: ¹⁴ But **their minds were blinded** ^[spiritual]: for until this day remaineth the same vail ^[spiritual] untaken away in the reading of the old testament; which vail ^[spiritual] is done away in Christ ^[spiritual rebirth]. ¹⁵ But even unto this day, when Moses is read, the vail is upon their heart ^[spiritual]. ¹⁶ Nevertheless when it ^[their heart] shall turn to the Lord, the vail ^[spiritual] shall be taken away ^[spiritual rebirth].

- The covering cast over all people and the vail that is cast over all nations (**Isaiah 25:7**) is removed in an individual when their mind/heart turns to the Lord Jesus Christ.

Acts 8:37

And Philip said, **If thou believest with all thine heart**, thou mayest. And he answered and said, I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God ^[1 John 4:15; reborn before he spoke].

Romans 10:10

For **with the heart man believeth unto righteousness**; and with the mouth confession is made unto salvation.

- Spiritual rebirth is purely an issue of the heart. Otherwise, the mute would have no hope.

Conclusion

The “*anointed cherub that covereth*” is the spirit Lucifer and he was ordained by God to physically cover the entire earth and/or be responsible for the physical covering of the earth (the air/*tou aeros*/the heaven/firmament). Spiritually, he is also responsible for covering/blinding the hearts/minds of every person that has willfully sinned against God and has not been set free by our High Priest Jesus Christ ([Isaiah 14:17c](#), [Isaiah 55:11](#)).

In *light* of all that, it seems very fitting that his name is “Lucifer” which is Latin for “light-bearer” because the atmosphere bears the light from the sun. Note that dictionaries that define Lucifer as “the morning star” are a perversion of truth because they deify Satan ([Revelation 22:16](#)).

He appears to be physically represented as the vail in the tabernacle/temple.

He was created as a wonderfully beautiful and astoundingly powerful spirit with high authority and he is near to the throne of God. He appears to still have access to God’s presence and mingles with the sons of God ([Job 1:6](#), [2:1](#), [Matthew 13:24-30](#), [John 6:70](#), [Revelation 12:10](#)).

He can likely take on any physical form he desires. He can call down fire from heaven, create pestilences, give life to inanimate objects, and likely many other untold miracles and wonders as God permits.

But, for all his “wisdom” and power he also has many weaknesses simply because he has no truth in him ([John 17:17](#)): therefore he cannot speak, hear, understand, or believe the word of God. He also seems to be thoroughly deceived in thinking that he can defeat God ([Revelation 20:3](#)).

He is very angry and his objectives are to kill, steal, destroy, and [Isaiah 14:13,14](#).

Notes that didn't make it into the final cut
(because 9 pages)

The four living creatures in [Ezekiel](#) are below the firmament which the throne is in. The four beasts in [Revelation 4:6,7](#) are around the throne which is in the firmament which is above the living creatures in [Ezekiel](#). When put together we see two separate groups of creatures around and below the throne of God. Moreover, both the faces of the living creatures below ([Ezekiel 1:1,10, 10:14,22](#)) and the beasts above each perfectly align with the four closest tribes (excluding Levi) that camped around the tabernacle ([Numbers 2](#)): Judah/Lion/East, Reuben/Man/South, Ephraim/Ox or Cherub/West, Dan/Eagle/North. We know the face of the Cherub was an Ox because of [Ezekiel 1:1,10, 10:14,22](#).

Regarding “*son of the morning*” ([Isaiah 14:12](#), [Job 38:7](#)):

Genesis 1:1-5 ¹ In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth. ² And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness was upon the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters.	The first evening	The first day
³ And God said, Let there be light: and there was light. ⁴ And God saw the light, that it was good: and God divided the light from the darkness. ⁵ And God called the light Day, and the darkness he called Night. And the evening and the morning were the first day.	The first morning	
Genesis 1:6-8 ⁶ And God said, Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters. ⁷ And God made the firmament, and divided the waters which were under the firmament from the waters which were above the firmament: and it was so. ⁸ And God called the firmament Heaven. And the evening and the morning were the second day.		The second day

- The first day elapsed before the earth was created.
 - If Lucifer is a son of the first morning, then he was created in the latter half of the first day.
- The firmament/heaven was created on the second day.
 - Lucifer necessarily had to be created during or before this day.
- [Job 38:7](#) could not have occurred before [Genesis 1:9](#).